

Here's the full curation for **fast**, anchored to the passage phrase **"In a fast-paced world..."**
The passage itself uses the compound **fast-paced**, so I'm mapping the base word **fast** across speed, time, firmness, colour stability, clocks, abstaining from food, and key fixed expressions. The full **MCQ-ready master list** is included.

FAST

1. Passage anchor

> "In a **fast-paced** world, it has become a small anchor for me."

Passage meaning

fast-paced = happening or changing quickly, with a lot of activity and little time to slow down
節奏快速的 ; 步調很快的

Here, the speaker contrasts the modern world's rapid pace with the calming, grounding effect of writing by hand.

Practice

1. She works in a **fast-paced** environment.
她在一個**節奏很快的**環境中工作。
2. Life in a big city can feel extremely **fast-paced**.
大城市生活可能令人覺得**步調非常快**。

Core speed meanings

2. fast — moving quickly

= moving at high speed
快的 ; 快速的

Examples

1. That is a very **fast** car.
那是一輛很**快**的車。
2. He is a **fast** runner.
他是一名跑得很**快**的跑手。

This is the central everyday sense.

3. fast — happening quickly

= taking only a short time or happening rapidly

****快速的；迅速的****

Examples

1. We need a ****fast response****.

我們需要一個****快速回應****。

2. The company experienced ****fast growth****.

公司經歷了****快速增長****。

4. fast — able to do something quickly

= performing an activity at high speed

****動作快的；速度快的****

Examples

1. She is a ****fast reader****.

她閱讀速度很****快****。

2. He is a ****fast learner****.

他學東西學得很****快****。

Adverb: quickly

5. fast — quickly

As an adverb:

= at high speed

****快速地；很快地****

Examples

1. The car was moving ****fast****.

那輛車開得很****快****。

2. Time seems to pass **fast**.

時間似乎過得很**快**。

Important grammar point:

> **fast** can be both adjective and adverb.

6. run / drive / work fast

= perform an action quickly

跑得快 / 開得快 / 做得快

Examples

1. Don't drive too **fast**.

不要開得太**快**。

2. She works incredibly **fast**.

她工作得非常**快**。

Fast-paced

7. fast-paced

= involving rapid activity, change, or pressure

節奏快速的 ; 步調快的

This is the exact passage compound.

Examples

1. Journalism can be a **fast-paced** profession.

新聞業可以是一個**節奏快速的**行業。

2. He enjoys the energy of a **fast-paced workplace**.

他喜歡**步調快的工作環境**所帶來的活力。

Time / duration

8. fast — quick to happen

= occurring sooner than expected or taking little time

****很快發生的；迅速的****

Examples

1. That was a ****fast recovery****.

那是一次****很快的康復****。

2. We saw a ****fast improvement**** in performance.

我們看到表現****迅速改善****。

Clock/watch

9. fast — clock shows a later time than the correct time

= running ahead of the correct time

****走快了的；快了****

Examples

1. My watch is five minutes ****fast****.

我的手錶****快了五分鐘****。

2. That clock runs ****fast****.

那個時鐘****走得太快****。

Distinct sense.

10. five minutes fast

= showing a time later than the real time

****快五分鐘****

Examples

1. Your clock is ten minutes ****fast****.

你的鐘****快了十分鐘****。

2. I keep my watch a few minutes ****fast**** on purpose.

我故意把手錶調****快幾分鐘****。

Firm / fixed

11. fast — firmly fixed

= firmly attached or fixed in position

****牢固的；緊固的****

Older/formal but still visible in compounds and expressions.

Examples

1. The rope was made ****fast**** to the post.

繩子被****牢牢固定****在柱子上。

2. The door was held ****fast****.

門被****牢牢固定住****。

Lower priority in ordinary modern speech.

Hold fast

12. hold fast

= remain firm, fixed, or loyal

****緊緊抓住；堅守****

Examples

1. ****Hold fast**** to the rope.

****緊緊抓住****繩子。

2. She ****held fast to**** her principles.

她****堅守****自己的原則。

Literal and figurative.

Fast asleep

13. fast asleep

= sleeping deeply

****熟睡的；沉睡的****

Examples

1. The child was ****fast asleep****.

那個孩子已經****熟睡****。

2. He fell ****fast asleep**** on the sofa.

他在沙發上****沉沉睡著了****。

Here, ****fast**** does not mean “quickly.”

Colour stability

14. fast — resistant to fading or running

= able to keep its colour when washed, exposed to light, etc.

****不褪色的；色牢度高的****

Usually in compounds such as:

* colourfast

* lightfast

Examples

1. The fabric is ****colourfast****.

這種布料****不易褪色****。

2. Artists need ****lightfast**** pigments.

藝術家需要****耐光、不易褪色的**顏料**。

Photography / optics

15. fast lens

= lens with a wide maximum aperture that can admit a lot of light

****大光圈鏡頭；高速鏡頭****

Examples

1. A **fast lens** is useful in low light.
大光圈鏡頭在低光環境下很有用。

2. She bought a **fast prime lens**.
她買了一支**大光圈定焦鏡頭**。

Technical but common in photography.

Computing / technology

16. fast — processing or operating quickly

= able to process information, transfer data, or respond rapidly
高速的；運算快的

Examples

1. This is a very **fast processor**.
這是一顆很**快的處理器**。

2. We need a **fast internet connection**.
我們需要**高速網絡連線**。

Same speed concept, useful modern extension.

Food abstinence

17. fast — verb: abstain from food

= deliberately eat no food, or very little food, for a period of time
禁食；齋戒

Examples

1. Some people **fast** for religious reasons.
有些人因宗教原因而**禁食**。

2. Patients may need to **fast** before certain tests.
病人在某些檢查前可能需要**禁食**。

This is a completely separate verb meaning.

18. fast — noun: period of abstaining from food

= period during which someone does not eat

禁食期；齋戒期

Examples

1. He ended his **fast** in the evening.

他晚上結束了**禁食**。

2. The religious **fast** lasts several hours.

宗教**齋戒期**持續幾個小時。

19. fasting

= not eating for a period of time

禁食；空腹

Examples

1. The test requires eight hours of **fasting**.

這項檢查要求**禁食八小時**。

2. She was **fasting** before the blood test.

她抽血前正在**空腹禁食**。

Related forms

20. fast-paced

= moving or developing rapidly

節奏快的

This is the exact passage family form.

21. fast-moving

= moving, changing, or developing quickly

****快速移動的；變化迅速的****

Examples

1. It is a ****fast-moving industry****.

這是一個****變化迅速的行業****。

2. The fire was ****fast-moving****.

火勢****蔓延得很快****。

22. fast-growing

= increasing quickly in size, number, or importance

****快速成長的****

Examples

1. It is a ****fast-growing company****.

那是一家****快速成長的公司****。

2. The city has a ****fast-growing population****.

那座城市人口****增長迅速****。

23. fast-track

A. noun/adjective: quicker route/process

****快速通道；加速程序****

B. verb: make something progress more quickly

****加速處理****

Examples

1. The application entered the ****fast-track process****.

申請進入****快速審批程序****。

2. The project was ****fast-tracked****.

專案被****加速推進****。

High-value expressions

24. as fast as possible

= as quickly as one can

****盡快；以最快速度****

Examples

1. Please respond ****as fast as possible****.

請****盡快****回覆。

2. He ran ****as fast as possible****.

他以****最快速度****奔跑。

25. fast and furious

= extremely rapid, energetic, and intense

****快速激烈的；緊湊刺激的****

Examples

1. The action was ****fast and furious****.

行動非常****快速而激烈****。

2. The first few minutes were ****fast and furious****.

最初幾分鐘節奏****緊湊激烈****。

26. live fast

= live an exciting, risky, or intense lifestyle

****過刺激 / 放縱的生活****

Examples

1. He had a reputation for ****living fast****.

他以****生活放縱刺激****聞名。

2. The phrase “live fast” often suggests risk-taking.

****live fast**** 常帶有冒險、放縱生活的意味。

27. fast lane

A. traffic lane for faster-moving vehicles

****快線；高速車道****

B. figurative high-pressure, exciting lifestyle

****快節奏生活；競爭激烈的環境****

Examples

1. The car moved into the ****fast lane****.

那輛車駛入****快線****。

2. She grew tired of life in the ****fast lane****.

她厭倦了****快節奏、高壓的生活****。

28. play fast and loose with

= treat rules, facts, or people carelessly or dishonestly

****隨意玩弄；不負責任地處理****

Examples

1. Don't ****play fast and loose with the facts****.

不要****隨意歪曲事實****。

2. The company was accused of ****playing fast and loose with the rules****.

公司被指控****不負責任地對待規則****。

Idiomatic; meaning not predictable from ordinary ****fast****.

Key contrasts

29. fast vs quick

****fast****

= usually emphasizes speed of movement, action, processing, or rate

****快的****

****quick****

= often emphasizes taking little time or responding rapidly

****迅速的****

Compare:

> a ****fast car****

> 很快的車

> a ****quick answer****

> 快速回答

There is considerable overlap.

30. fast vs rapidly

****fast****

can be adjective or adverb:

> a fast car

> drive fast

****rapidly****

is only an adverb:

> prices rose rapidly

Both can mean ****迅速地****, but ****rapidly**** sounds more formal.

31. fast vs early

****fast clock****

= showing a later time than the real time

****鐘走快了****

****early****

= happening before the expected time

****提早****

Compare:

> My watch is five minutes **fast**.

> 我的錶快五分鐘。

> I arrived five minutes **early**.

> 我提早五分鐘到。

32. fast vs busy

fast-paced

= events happen rapidly and continuously

節奏快

busy

= containing many tasks or activities

忙碌

A workplace can be busy without necessarily being fast-paced, though they often overlap.

33. fast vs rushed

fast

= simply quick; can be positive or neutral

快

rushed

= done too quickly because of insufficient time

倉促的

Compare:

> fast service

> 快速服務

> rushed work

> 倉促完成的工作

Meaning map

The central everyday concept of **fast** is:

****high speed****

From this develop:

Movement

fast car

→ ****快的車****

Action

work fast

→ ****做得快****

Change

fast growth

→ ****快速增長****

Passage

fast-paced world

→ ****步調快速的世界****

Technology

fast processor

→ ****高速處理器****

Other distinct branches include:

Clock

clock is fast

→ ****鐘走快了****

Firmness

hold fast

→ ****緊握 / 堅守****

Sleep

fast asleep

→ ****熟睡****

Colour

colourfast

→ **不褪色**

Food abstinence

fast

→ **禁食 / 齋戒**

Photography

fast lens

→ **大光圈鏡頭**

The passage uses the rapid-activity branch:

> **fast-paced world**

> → **節奏快速、事情接連不斷的世界**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
fast — movement	以高速移動的；快的
fast — process/change	在短時間內發生或迅速變化的；快速的
fast — person/ability	能以很高速度進行某項活動的
fast — adverb	以很快速度；快速地
fast-paced	活動多、變化快、節奏緊湊的
fast — clock/watch	顯示的時間比實際時間更晚；走快了的
fast — firmly fixed	牢牢固定、不容易移動的，較正式 / 舊式
hold fast — literal	緊緊抓住、不放開
hold fast — figurative	堅守信念、原則等
fast asleep	睡得很沉；熟睡的
colourfast/lightfast	顏色在清洗 / 光照下不容易褪色的
fast lens	最大光圈較大、能讓較多光進入的大光圈鏡頭
fast — computing/technology	處理、傳輸或回應速度高的
fast — verb food	一段時間內不進食；禁食 / 齋戒
fast — noun food	禁食或齋戒的一段時間
fasting	一段時間不進食的狀態；禁食 / 空腹
fast-moving	移動快或變化迅速的
fast-growing	規模、數量等快速增長的
fast-track	讓程序、專案等更快進行的快速通道 / 加速處理
fast lane — traffic	供較高速車輛使用的快線 / 高速車道

fast lane — figurative	快節奏、高壓、競爭激烈的生活方式	
fast and furious	節奏非常快而且激烈的	
play fast and loose with	對規則、事實等草率、不負責任甚至不誠實地處理	

Passage recap

> “In a **fast-paced** world, it has become a small anchor for me.”

Here:

fast-paced = **moving, changing, and demanding attention very quickly**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **節奏快速的**

* **步調很快的**

* **生活節奏緊湊的**

Natural contextual translation:

在這個生活節奏很快的世界裡，它對我來說已經變成一個小小的錨點。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

fast-paced

= **characterized by rapid activity, change, and little time to slow down**

節奏快速的；步調快的

The key contrast in the passage is:

> **fast-paced world**

> → 外界節奏很快、資訊與活動不斷

versus:

> writing slowly with the fountain pen

> → 放慢、思考、重新集中注意力

So **fast** here is not about a physically fast object. It describes the **pace of modern life**.